urged the management and the public to earnestly work for the success of the company.[102]

Clearly, not everyone was prepared to throw in the towel. A set of directors who wanted to continue with the revival efforts now took the lead. T.S. Subramania Pillai, B.K. Ramaier and K.R. Venkatarama Aiyar took charge as 'provisional trustees' of the company.[103] B.K. Ramaier appears to have been a new convert.

Focusing on coastal trade seemed to be a way out of deep waters. But the steamers would have to be surveyed before they could sail out of Colombo. Carrying out this survey would require docking, an expensive proposition: Rs 1,500 for the first 48 hours, Rs 200 per day thereafter up to the 28th day, increasing to Rs 300 per day from the 29th day. The minimum cost of repairs would pile up to Rs 20,000. The DSP concluded with great satisfaction: the Swadeshi company 'would have to work wonders before they realize the profits shown in the forecast'.[104]

Meanwhile, the 'provisional trustees' issued a statement which details what this meant. Calling upon well-wishers in various parts of the country to join them, they said, only twelve debentures of Rs 1,000 had been sold (presumably in addition to the earlier 107). If everyone subscribed to the increased authorized capital, the company would be on a sure footing. Pointing to the calculations made by the company, they said, the company would start making at least modest profits soon. The newly raised capital, through share applications and debenture bonds, the trustees stated, would be held by them in trust, and invested in the South India Bank in Tirunelveli and Tuticorin and in the Indian Bank in Madurai and Madras. This arrangement would continue until the end of the year, and the provisional trustees would convene a meeting of all the contributors at the beginning of 1910. Those who had contributed more than Rs 100 would be informed directly by post, and public notices to others would be issued through papers such as *The Hindu*, *Swadesamitran*, *Vijaya* and *India*. Contributions of Rs 25 would entail one vote. The entire collection would be handed over to the company if the meeting believed that ploughing in all the contributions would help, and shares and debentures would be issued in the